



LUNDS
UNIVERSITET

Annual Report 2025

Deviations from Good Research Practice Review Board



Definitions of deviation from good research practice

Research misconduct, according to Section 2 of the Act (2019:504), refers to a serious deviation from good research practice in the form of fabrication, falsification or plagiarism that is committed intentionally or through gross negligence when planning, conducting or reporting research.

Investigated by the *National Board for Assessment of Research Misconduct* (Npof).

Other deviation from good research practice refers to matters that risk damaging, or damage, the integrity of the research process, research or researchers, and that is committed intentionally or through gross negligence when planning, conducting or reporting research.

Investigated by the *Deviations from Good Research Practice Review Board*. Decisions are taken by the Vice-Chancellor in accordance with the University's Guidelines (STYR 2022/2737).



Board for Investigation of Deviations from Good Research Practice at Lund University

Mission

- Assess other deviations from good research practice (not misconduct) according to university guidelines (STYR 2025/1270).

Composition

- Five faculty representatives, one administrative lawyer (LU), and one legally qualified member (current or former judge)
- Representative for LUS in cases involving doctoral students.
- The board is assisted by one or more staff members.

Who is covered by the Board's investigation?

Researcher

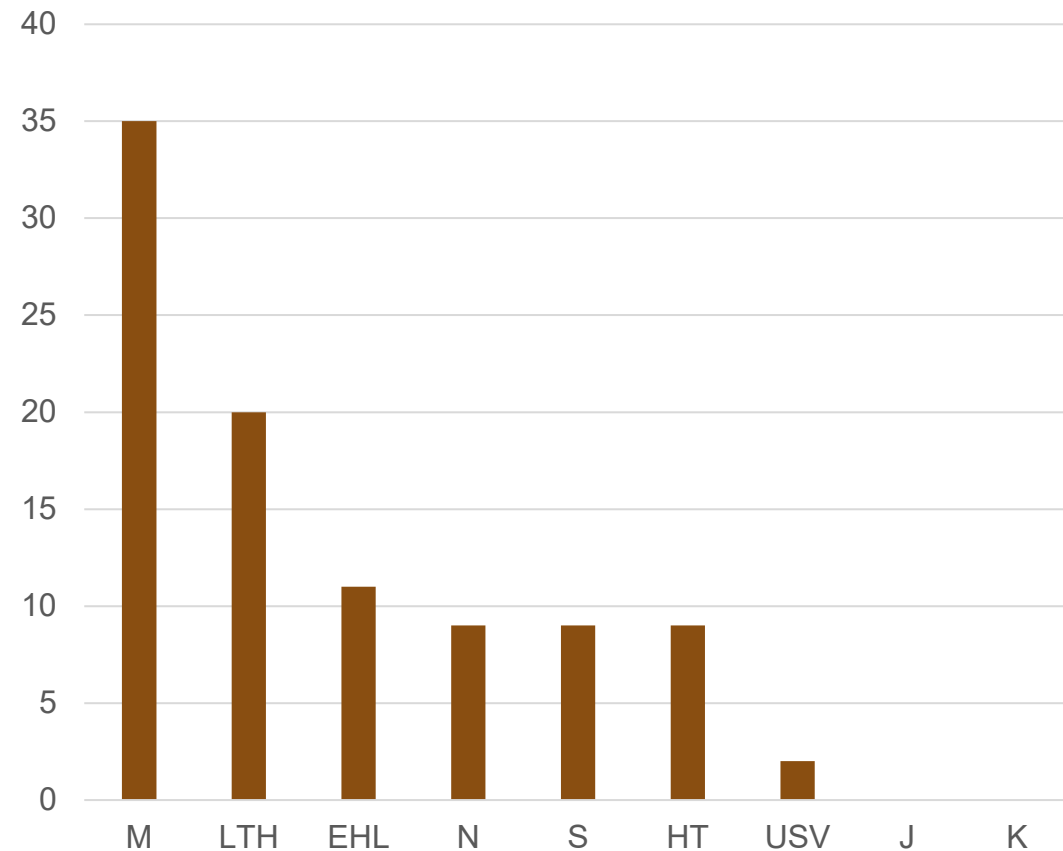
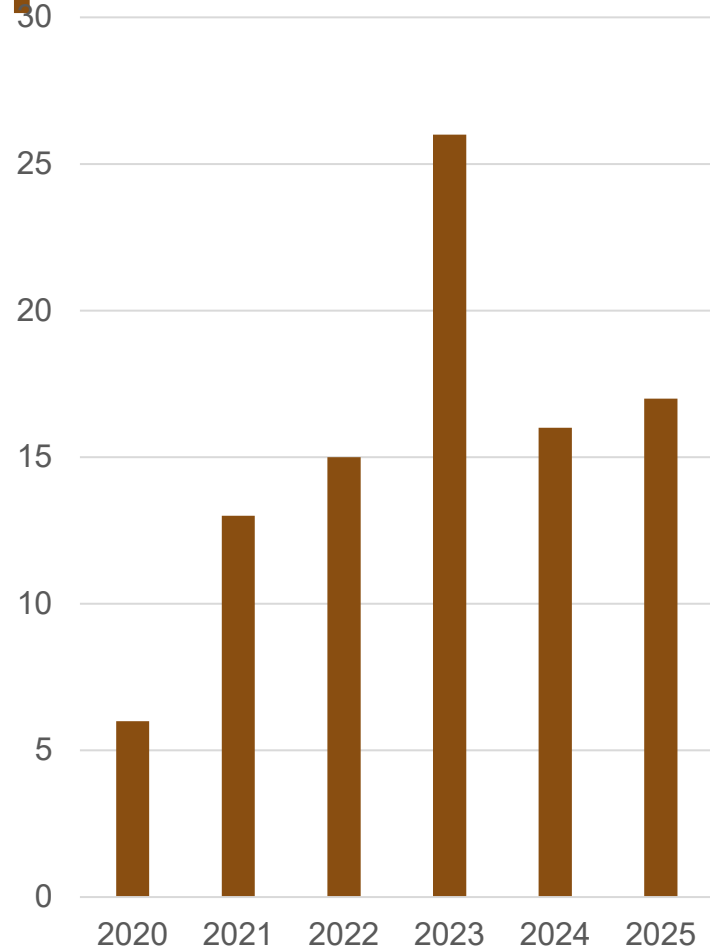
A person who has completed, or is currently involved in, third-cycle studies.

Employees at Lunds University

In exceptional cases the Board may also investigate researchers who, although not employed at LU, have a clear affiliation.

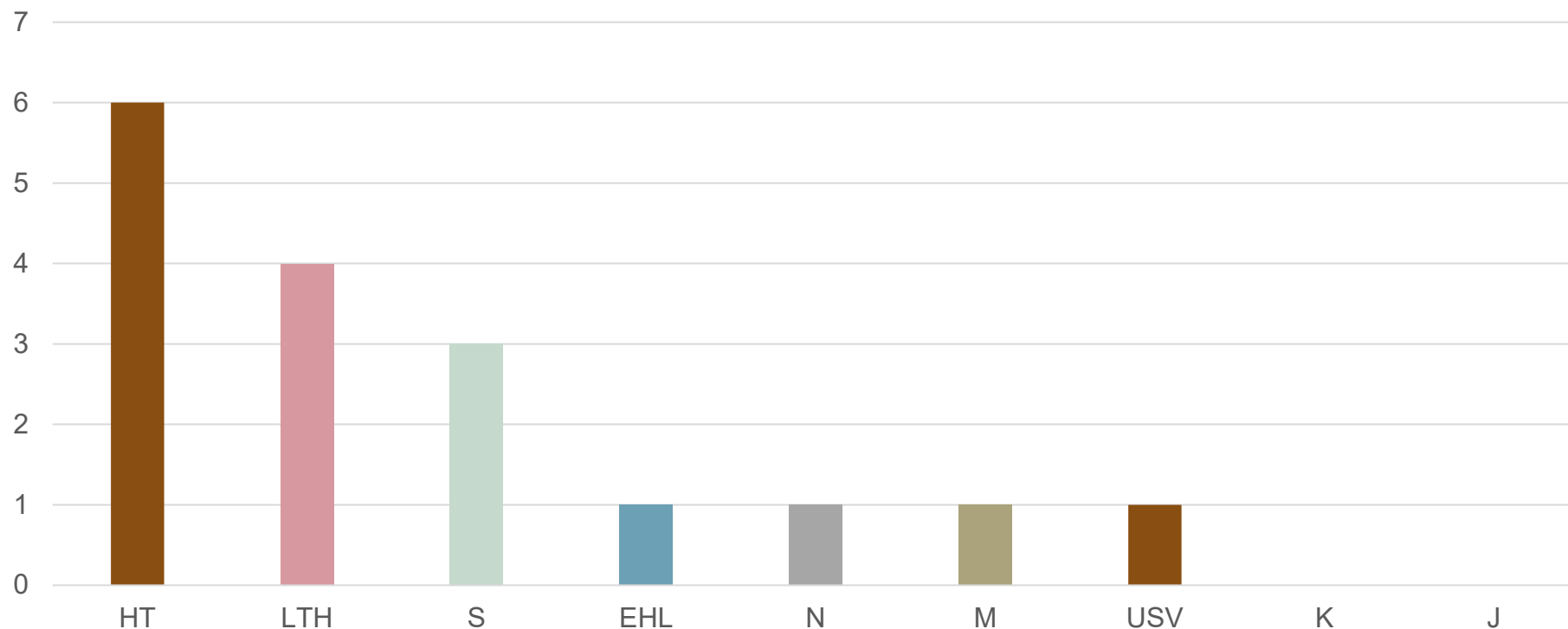


93 reports were recieved in the period 2020-2025



New reports in 2025

- **17 reports were received in 2025**
 - 12 reports concerned *other deviation from good research practise* (LU)
 - 4 reports concerned *research misconduct* (Npof)
 - 1 report concerned both *other deviation from good research practise* and *research misconduct* (LU and Npof)
- **Npof received 47 reports in 2025 (10 concerned LU)**





Decisions in 2025

The Vice-Chancellor took decisions on 13 cases *concerning suspicions of other deviation from good research practice in 2025 (regardless of the year reports were received)*

- 10 “not-guilty” decisions
- 3 decisions where the report was written off after investigation

Npof took decisions in 40 cases, 8 of those *concerning researchers at LU in 2025 (regardless of the year reports were received)*

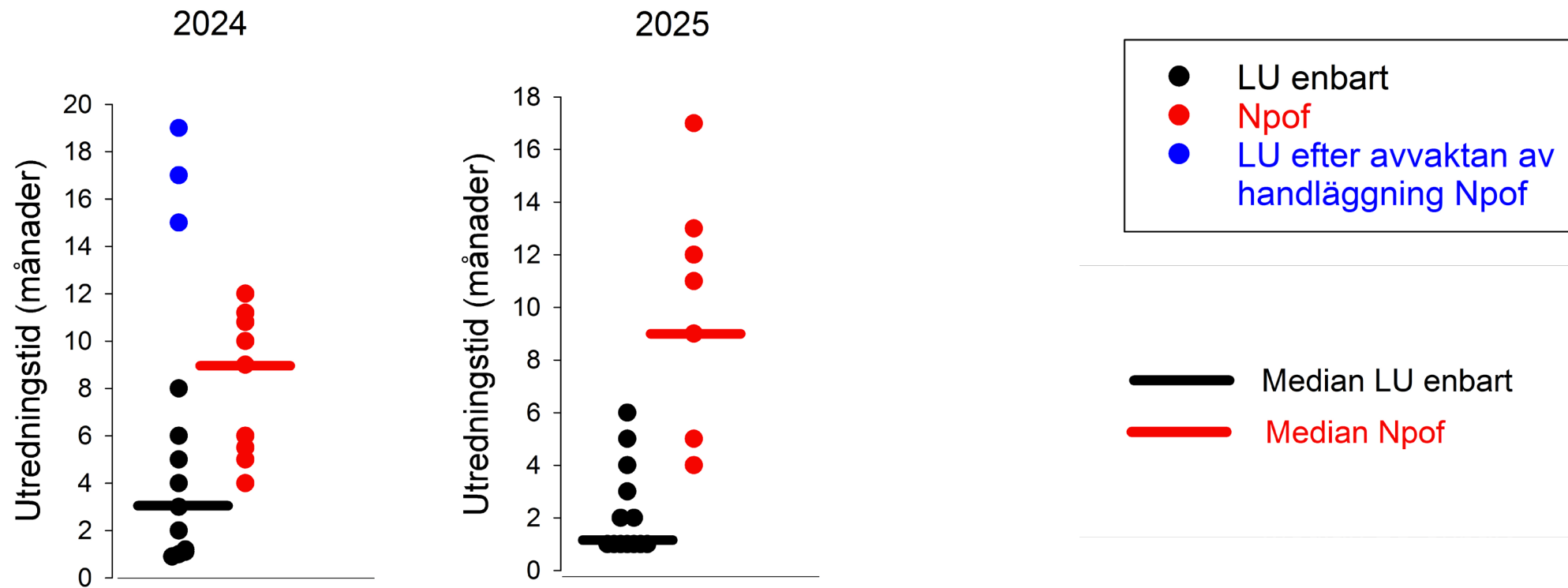
- 7 “not-guilty” decisions
- 1 “guilty”

“Not-guilty”= no confirmed deviation from good research practice or not guilty of research misconduct

“Guilty” = confirmed deviation from good research practice or guilty of research misconduct



Investigation period for decisions taken in 2025



Examples of reported suspected deviations

- Unclear authorship
- Research without required permits
- Research not following decisions/permits (e.g., EPM, Medical Products Agency)
- Reporting as a tool in ongoing conflict
- Difficulties in collaboration between doctoral student and supervisor
- AI use without control—fabrication in reference lists
- Plagiarism—text and/or image
- Reports not related to planning, execution, or reporting of research (e.g., media statements, reviews, unethical behavior)





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